risks of an intruder stealing or damaging the hardware itself, due to physical protections (fences, walls, locks, surveillance cameras, and so on) and the vetting and monitoring of staff that work in those environments. But an attacker may be able to gain control of the *resources* that the hardware provides through weaknesses in the operating system or software running on it. If they can install their own software, they may be able to use your hardware to perform their own actions and stop your legitimate software from functioning correctly.

In short, anything connected with your system that has value to somebody should be considered an asset. Put another way, if anybody would suffer real or perceived harm if some part of the system was compromised, that part should be considered an asset to be protected. That harm may be direct, such as loss of money, or it may be more abstract, such as loss of reputation. For example, if you do not properly protect your users' passwords and they are stolen by an attacker, the users may suffer direct harm due to the compromise of their individual accounts, but your organization would also suffer reputational damage if it became known that you had not followed basic security precautions.

1.4.2 Security goals

Security goals are used to define what security actually means for the protection of your assets. There is no single definition of security, and some definitions can even be contradictory! You can break down the notion of security in terms of the goals that should be achieved or preserved by